

5 November 2025

Group 2

Industry Talk by PPG

**Speaker: Patrick Thong, PPG SAP CoE
Operation Stream Lead, APAC**

Summary

The talk highlighted how PPG operate as a global leader in paints and coatings while following "The PPG Way", which emphasizes on collaboration, ownership, trust and continuous improvement. PPG protects and enhances a wide range of assets from landmarks and vehicles to homes and consumer products through its three main business units: Global Architectural Coatings, Performance Coatings and Industrial Coatings.



The talk also explained on how SAP S/4HANA serves as the backbone of PPG's worldwide operations. It enables smooth end-to-end workflows and support PPG's global scale. Moreover, SAP expertise is highly valuable today due to its global demand, innovation and career stability that make it a strong pathway for future digital professionals.

Technology Used and Issues Discussed

The core technology discussed by Patrick Thong was SAP, which serves as PPG's central ERP system for managing its complex and global operations. The company utilized the SAP S/4HANA system, which integrates key business process including Demand to Replenish (DTR), Order to Cash (OTC), Procure to Pay (PTP) and Record to Report (RTR). PPG used dedicated SAP modules like Materials Management (MM), Production Planning (PP) and Financial Accounting (FI). The implementation supports an extensive end-to-end flow, covering everything from generating a Purchase Order (PO), payment process, managing Sales Orders and deliveries to PPG's customers.

However, implement and managing a global system causes significant challenges. The speaker highlighted that managing a worldwide SAP involves dealing with different time zones across the world, having frequent late meetings to coordinate across regions. Additionally, the role demands that team members be able to travel to various sites internationally to support implementation activities and troubleshooting.

REFLECTION - DAYANG

The talk expanded my understanding to how Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) systems function in a real business environment. I was amazed by how PPG can successfully implement and maintain such a complex system like SAP S/4HANA worldwide, especially considering the operational challenges of managing different time zones and frequent late meetings. Understanding this motivates me as it shows that powerful systems can help human life by ensuring product quality and market stability which are essential for a reliable company. After this industrial talk session, I feel excited to know more about enterprise system design and how I can specialize in this field in the future.

REFLECTION - FARRA

This talk helped me to understand how a big company like PPG works behind the scenes. They show on how important Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) systems and technology like SAP running through in their businesses. I also finally clearly understood on how SAP connects all different part of a business into one system so that the whole company can work smoothly. In addition, I learned that managing a global ERP system is not just about using software but also involves in teamwork, communications and dealing with challenges like different time zones. This talk helped me see how ERP is used in real life and why these skills are valuable in today's digital workplace.

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